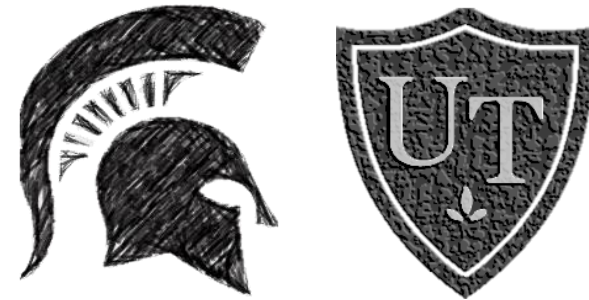


Rising Matriculation Age and the Cost of Delay

ARKESH DAS^[1]^[2]



¹Michigan State University College of Natural Science (2023-2026)

²University of Toledo College of Medicine and Life Sciences (2026-2030)

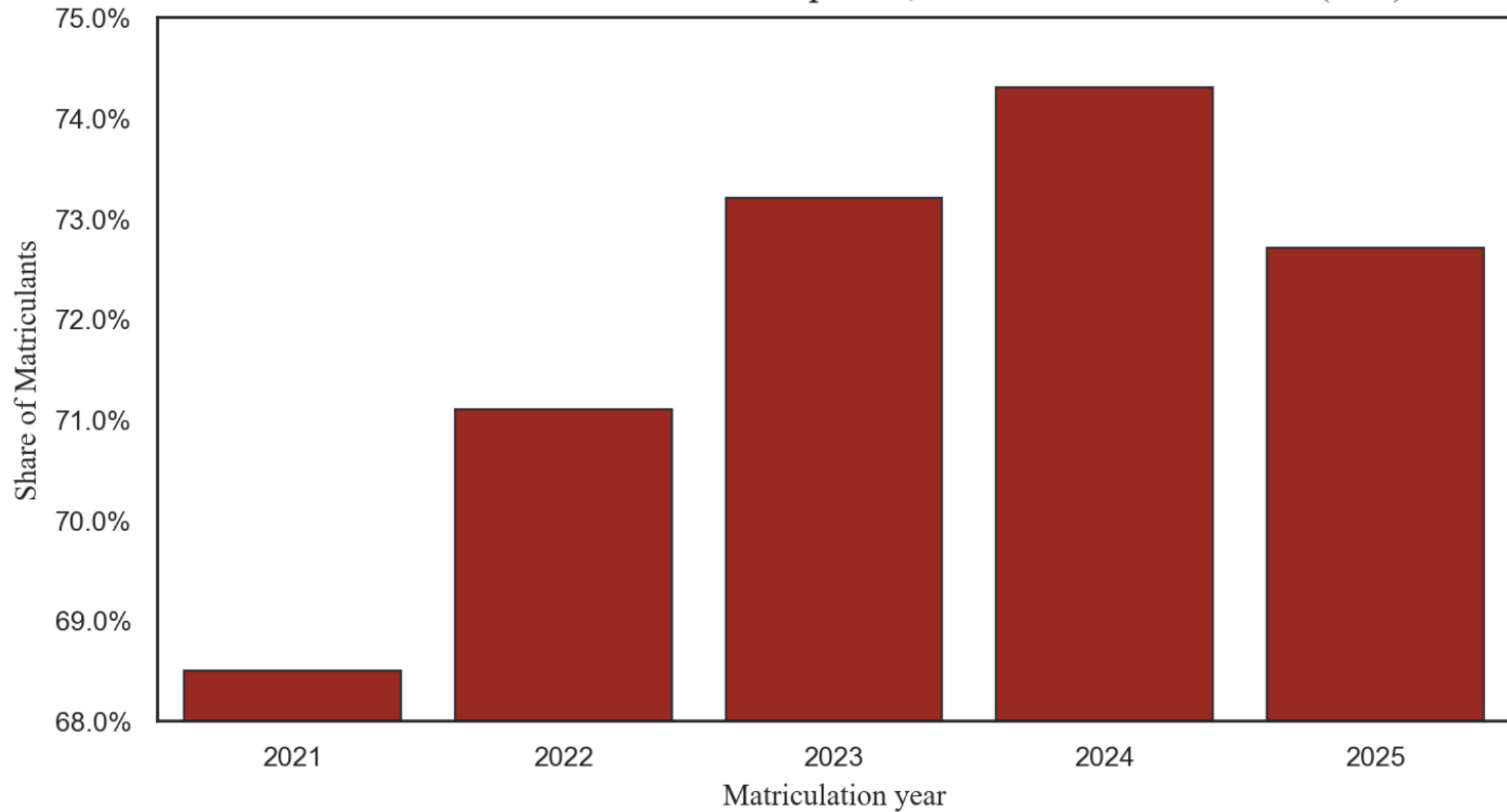
FUELING **TOMORROWS**

I AM
ACCEPTED
@UTOLEDOMED

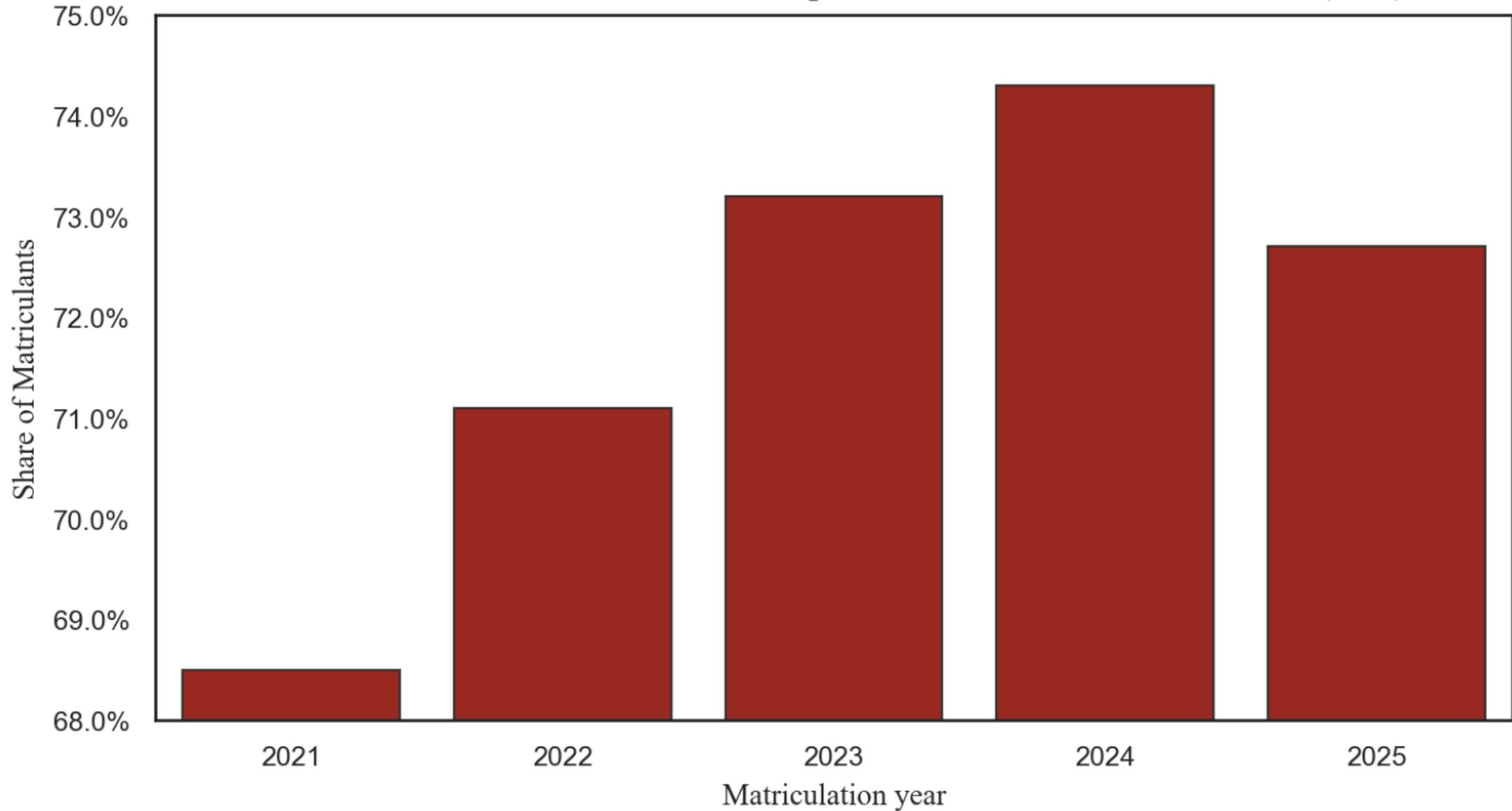


THE GROWTH YEAR

Matriculants Who've Taken ≥ 1 Gap Year, All US Medical Schools (MD)



Matriculants Who've Taken ≥ 1 Gap Year, All US Medical Schools (MD)

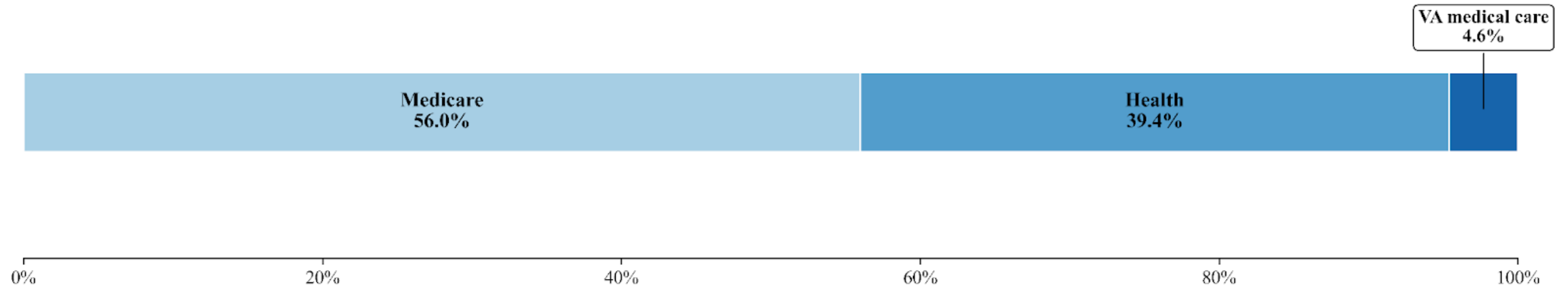


○ **2017: 62.6% of entering MD students reported taking at least one gap year**

Total Federal Spending (Fiscal Year-to-Date)



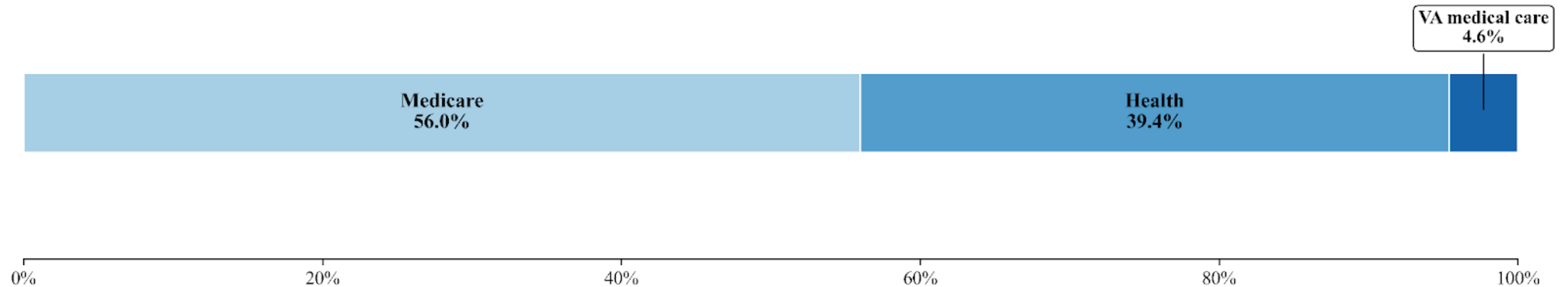
Healthcare Spending (Fiscal Year-to-Date)



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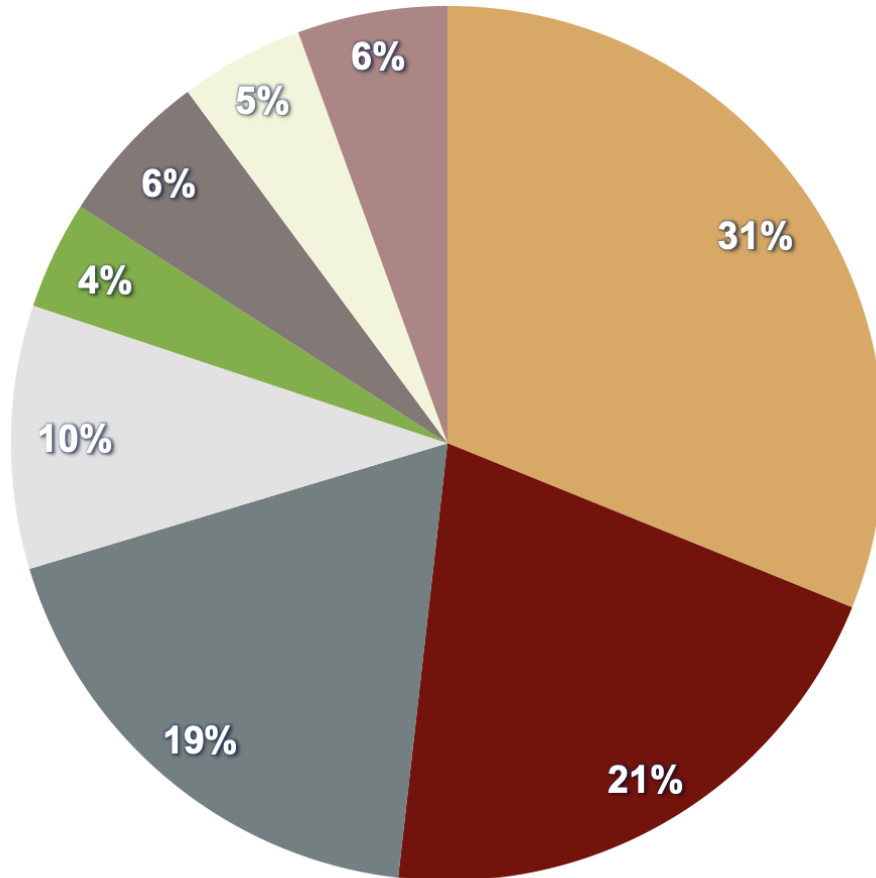
Healthcare Spending (Fiscal Year-to-Date)



○ **≈ 1/3 federal dollars to healthcare: largest area of public investment**

Revenue by Source for U.S. MD-Granting Schools, FY 2024

Recorded Revenues

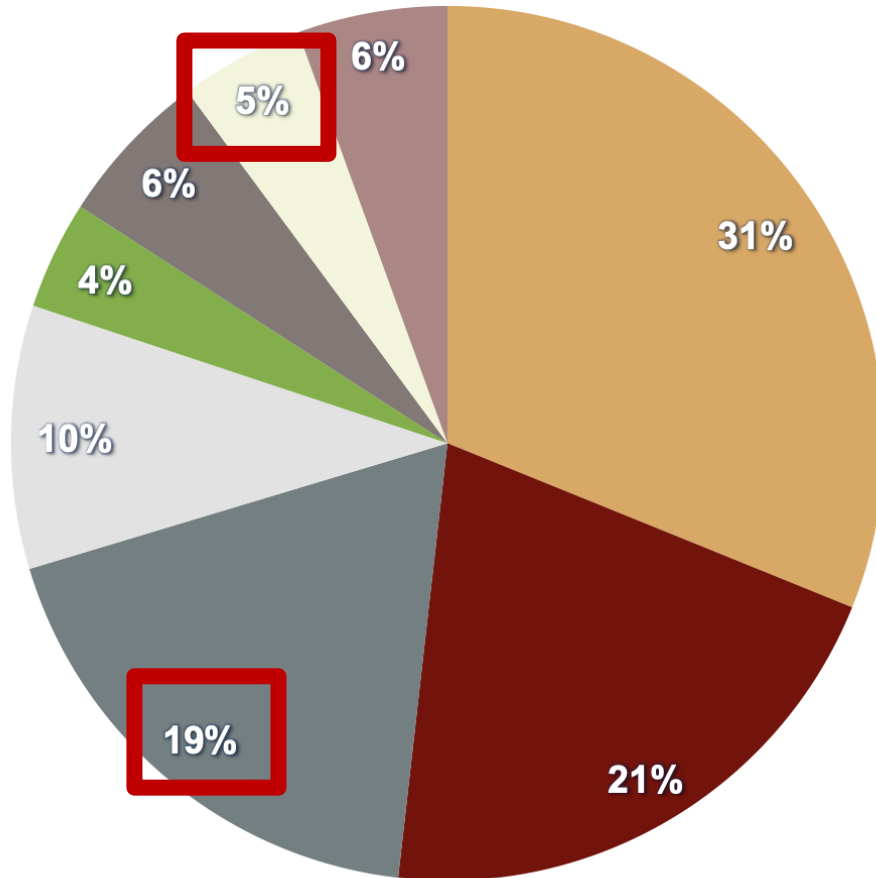


Median = \$320M

- Hospital
- Government and Parent Support
- Miscellaneous Sources
- Federal Grants and Contracts
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- Practice Plan
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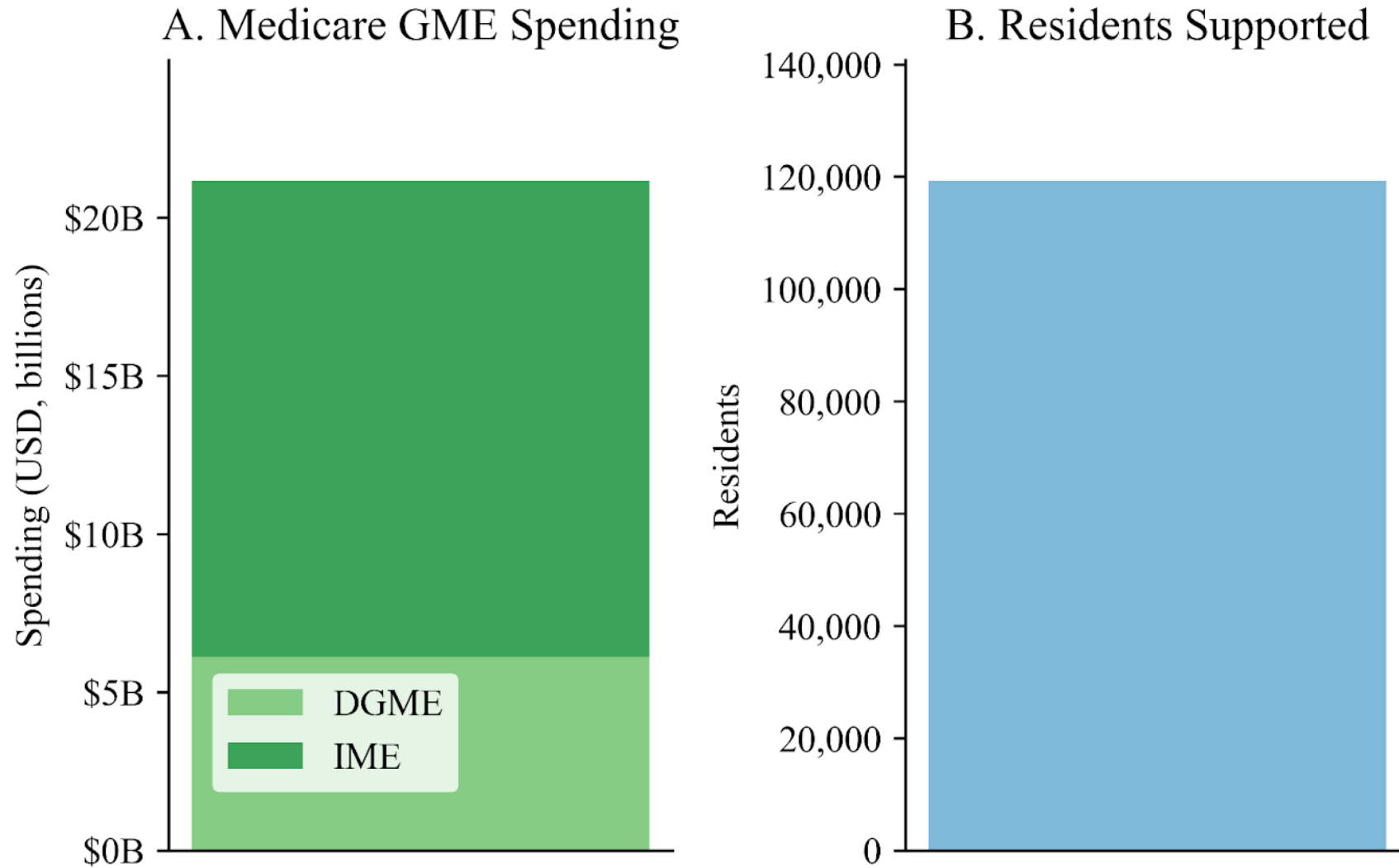
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Medicare Graduate Medical Education Spending and Supported Residents



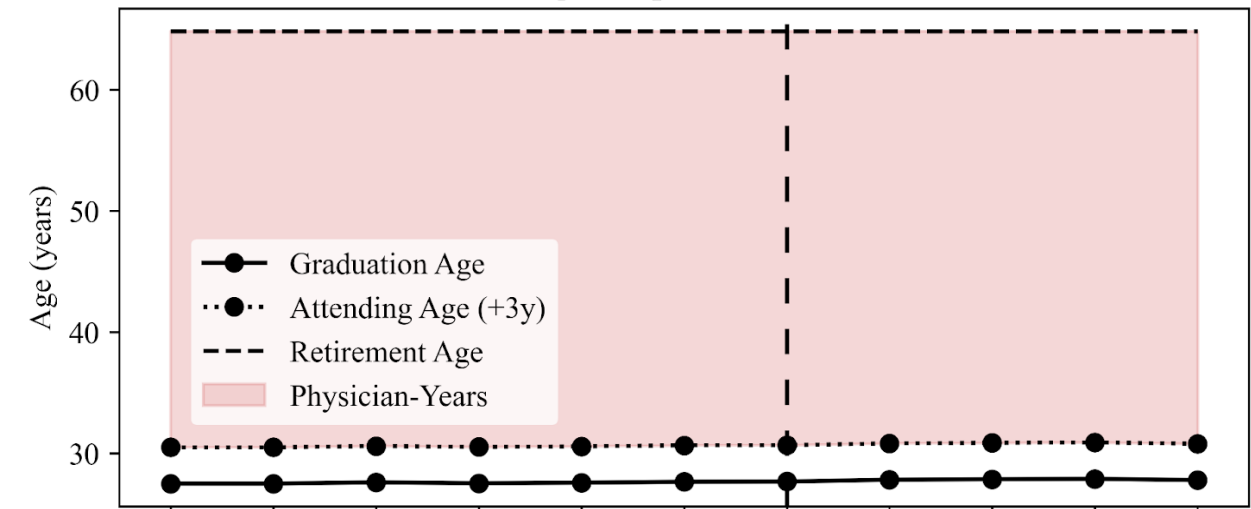
- Medicare is the largest single source of federal GME funding

THE PUBLIC INVESTMENT

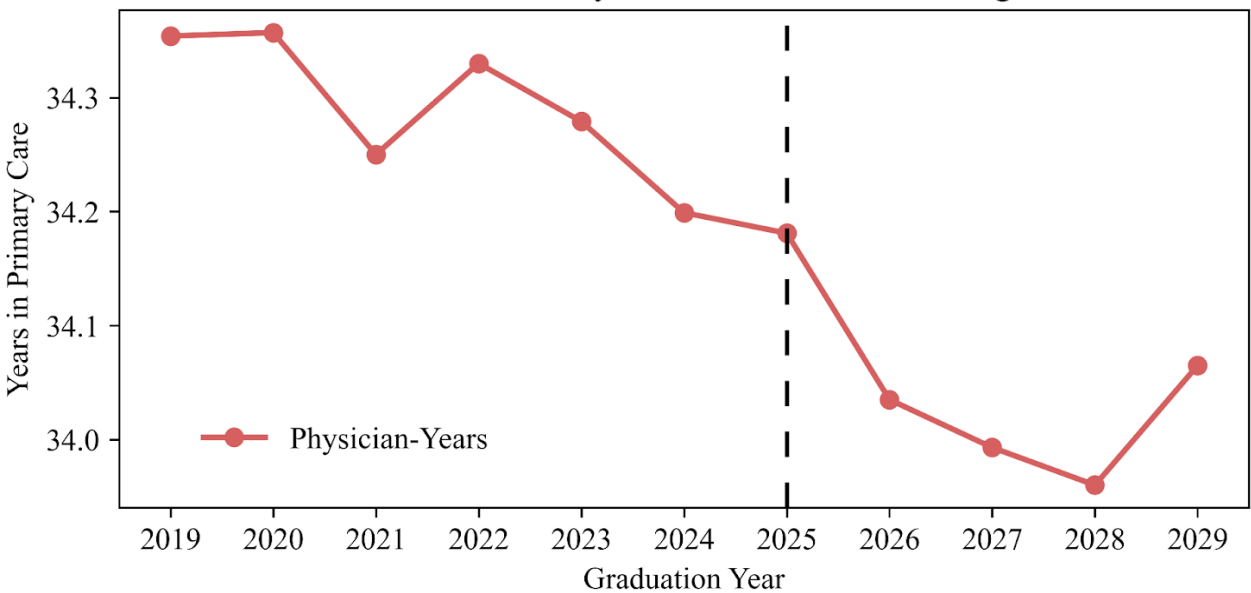


Delayed Medical Training and Projected Clinical Service Years in Primary Care

A. Training Completion to Retirement



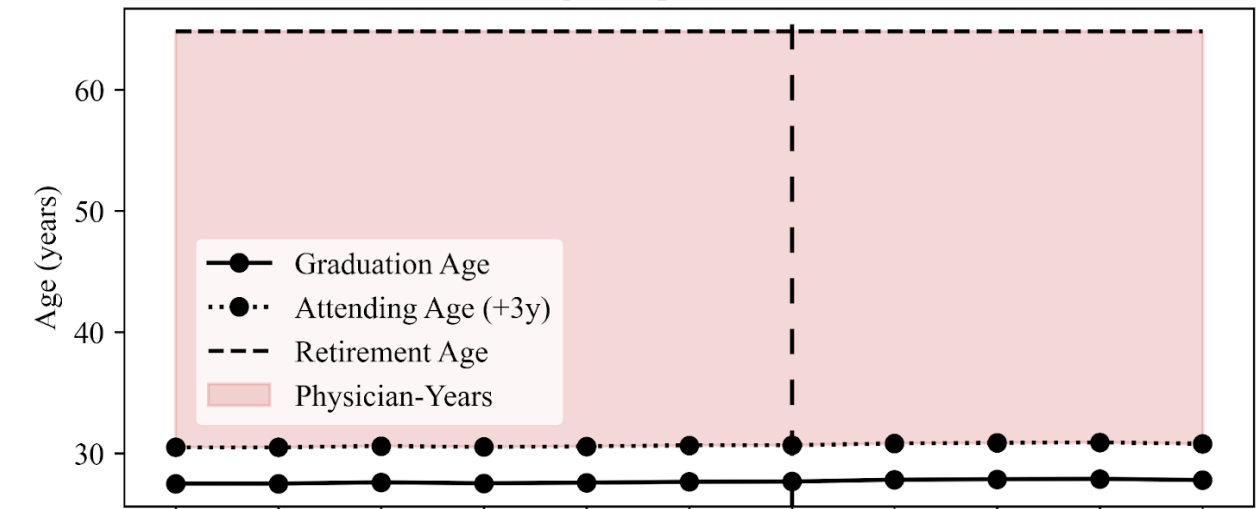
B. Estimated Physician-Years After Training



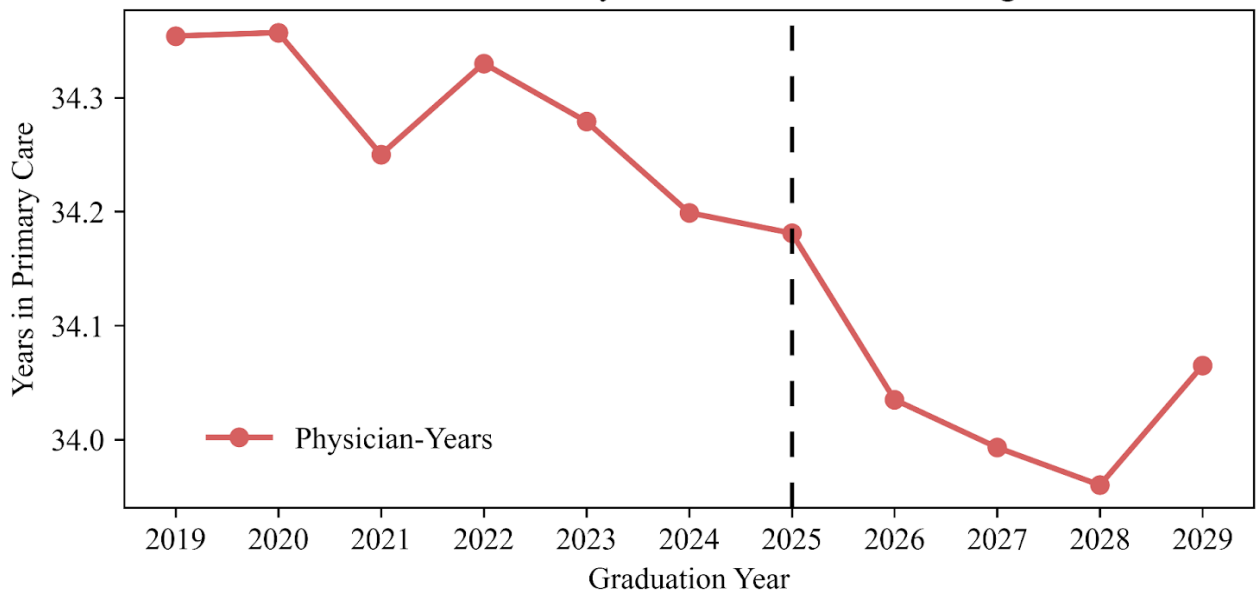
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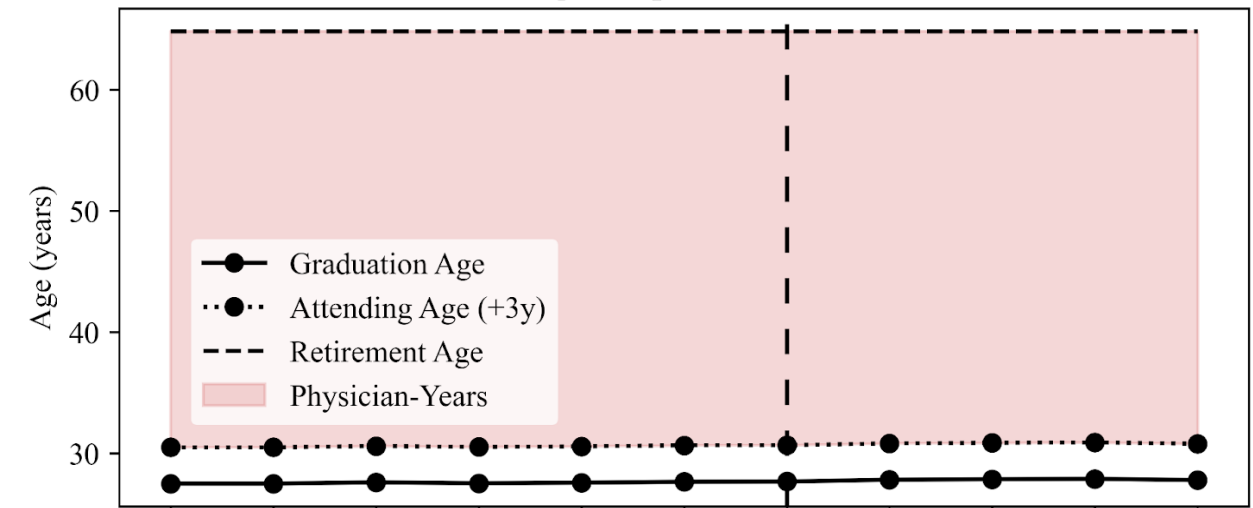


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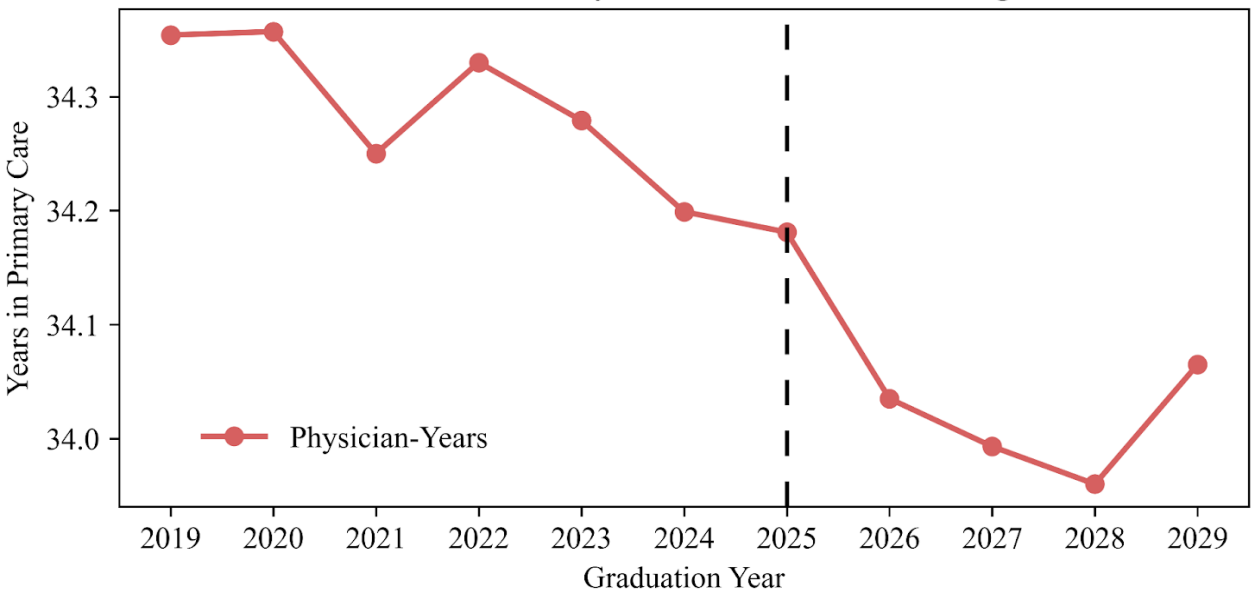


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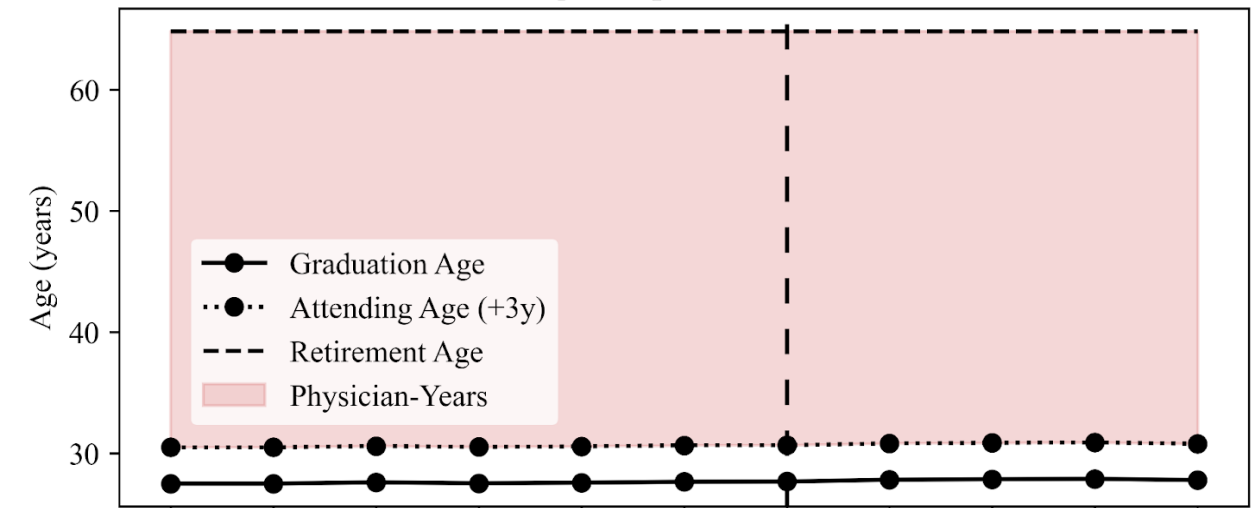


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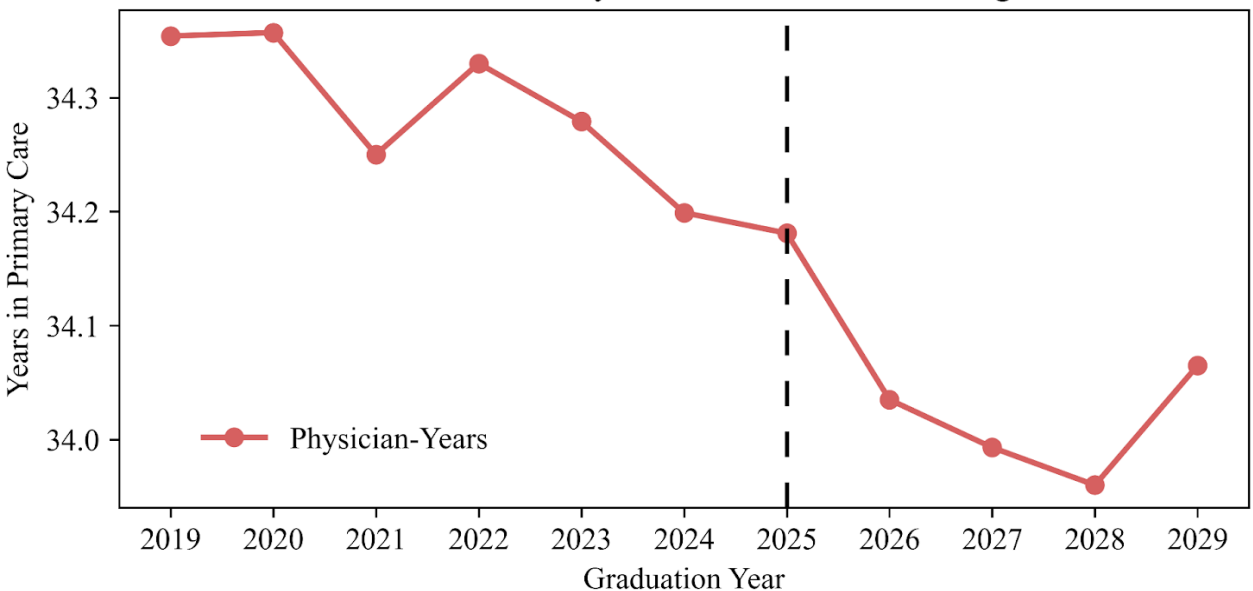
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Delayed Medical Training and Projected Clinical Service Years in Primary Care

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B. Estimated Physician-Years After Training



- **Mean physician-years decline: 34.36 to 33.96 years $\approx$ 5 months**
- **100,723 students -> 40,000 physician-years**
- **If graduation age increased by 1 year: equivalent to eliminating 2,900 full primary care careers from the workforce**

THE HIDDEN COSTS

The Hidden Costs

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 - Sustained high-pressure performance prior to entry into practice
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“..provide experiences for medical students to help them care for underserved and vulnerable populations with sensitivity and expertise...”



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 - 65 of 176 U.S. MD-granting schools explicitly reference primary care

The Hidden Costs

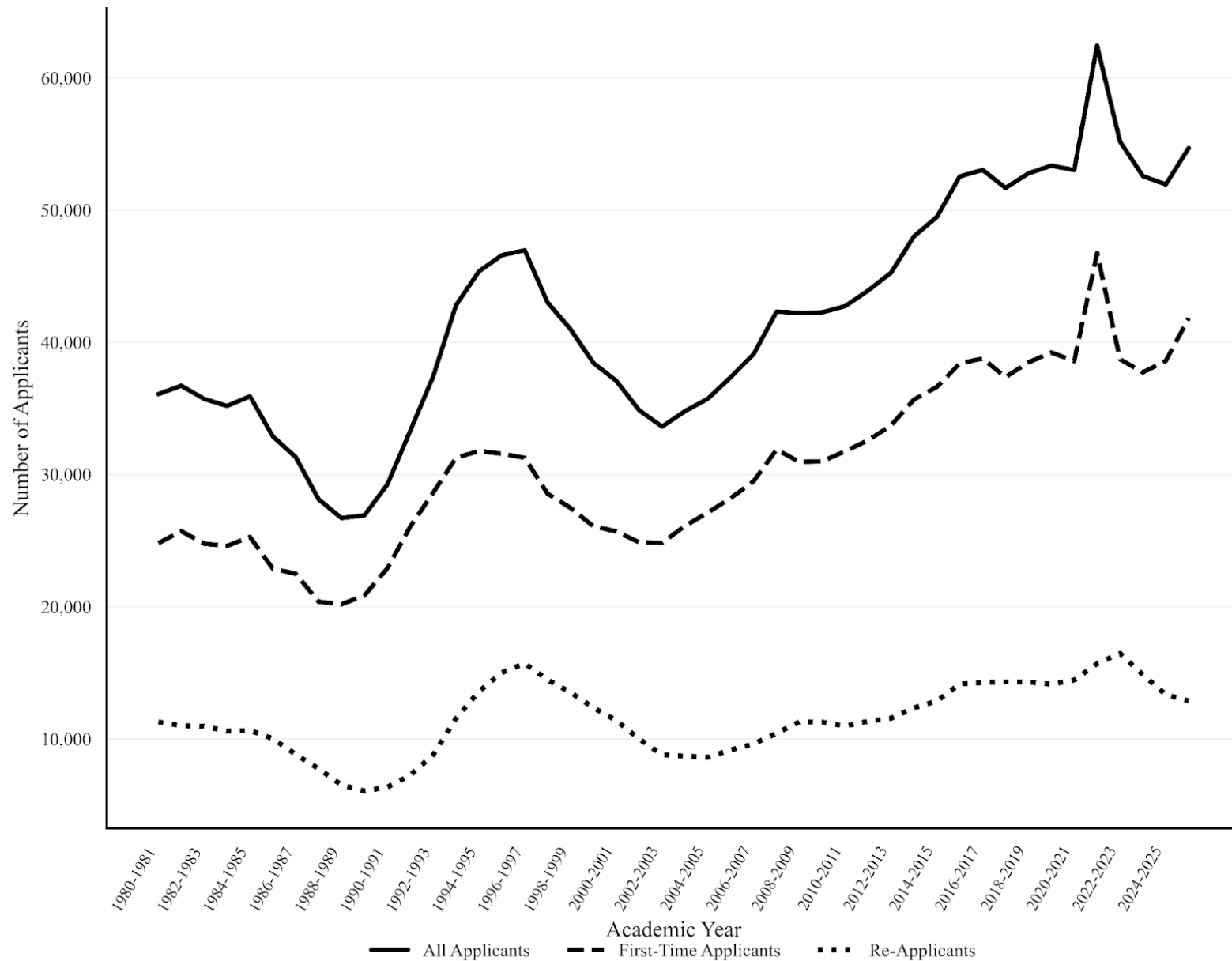
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- **Are the factors we use to admit people into medical school really selecting for people who want to practice in Underserved and Rural communities?**

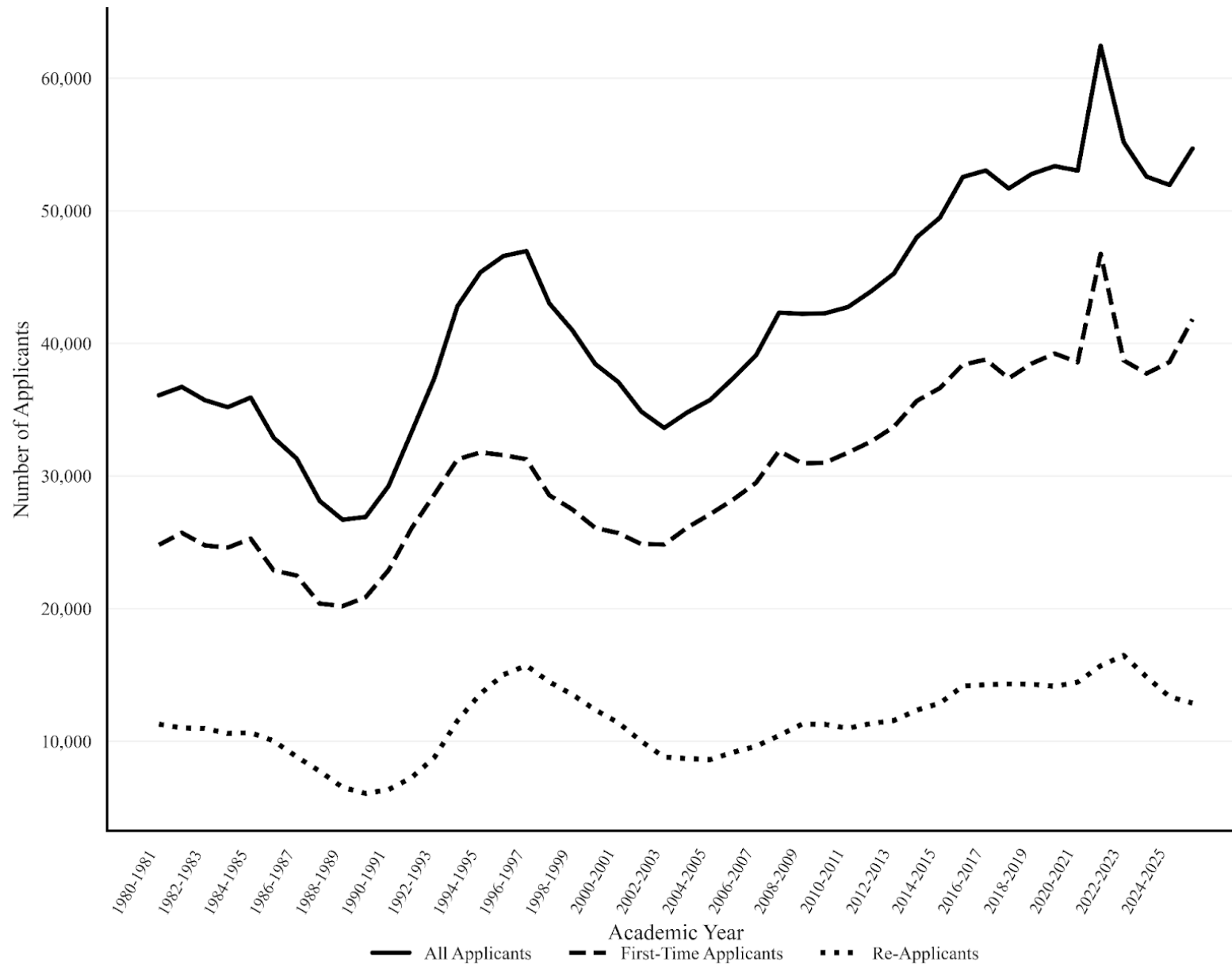
WHY IS THIS HAPPENING

Applicants, First-Time Applicants, and Repeat Applicants to U.S. Medical Schools, 1980-1981 through 2025-2026



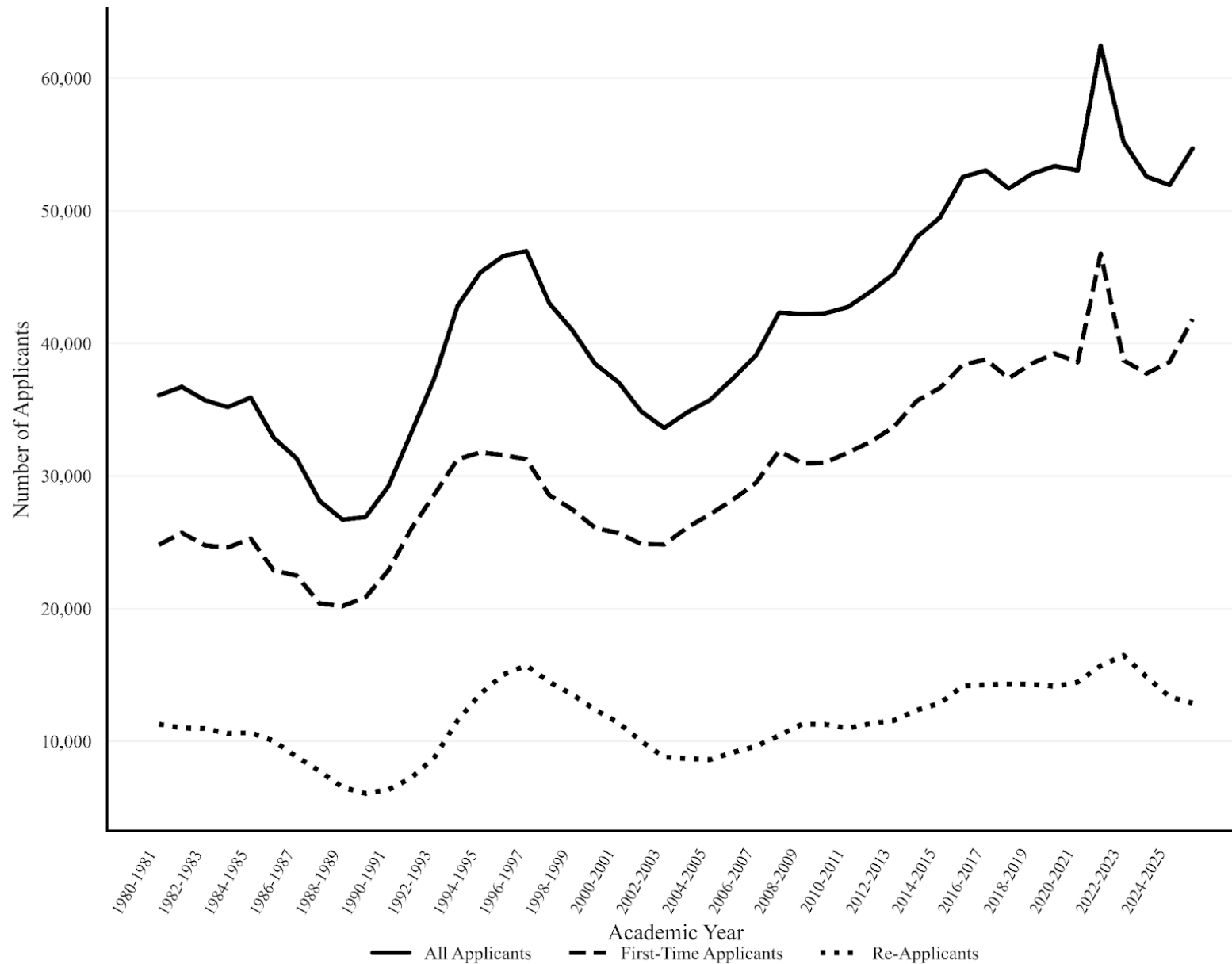
○ **2024-2025: 54,000 applicants,**
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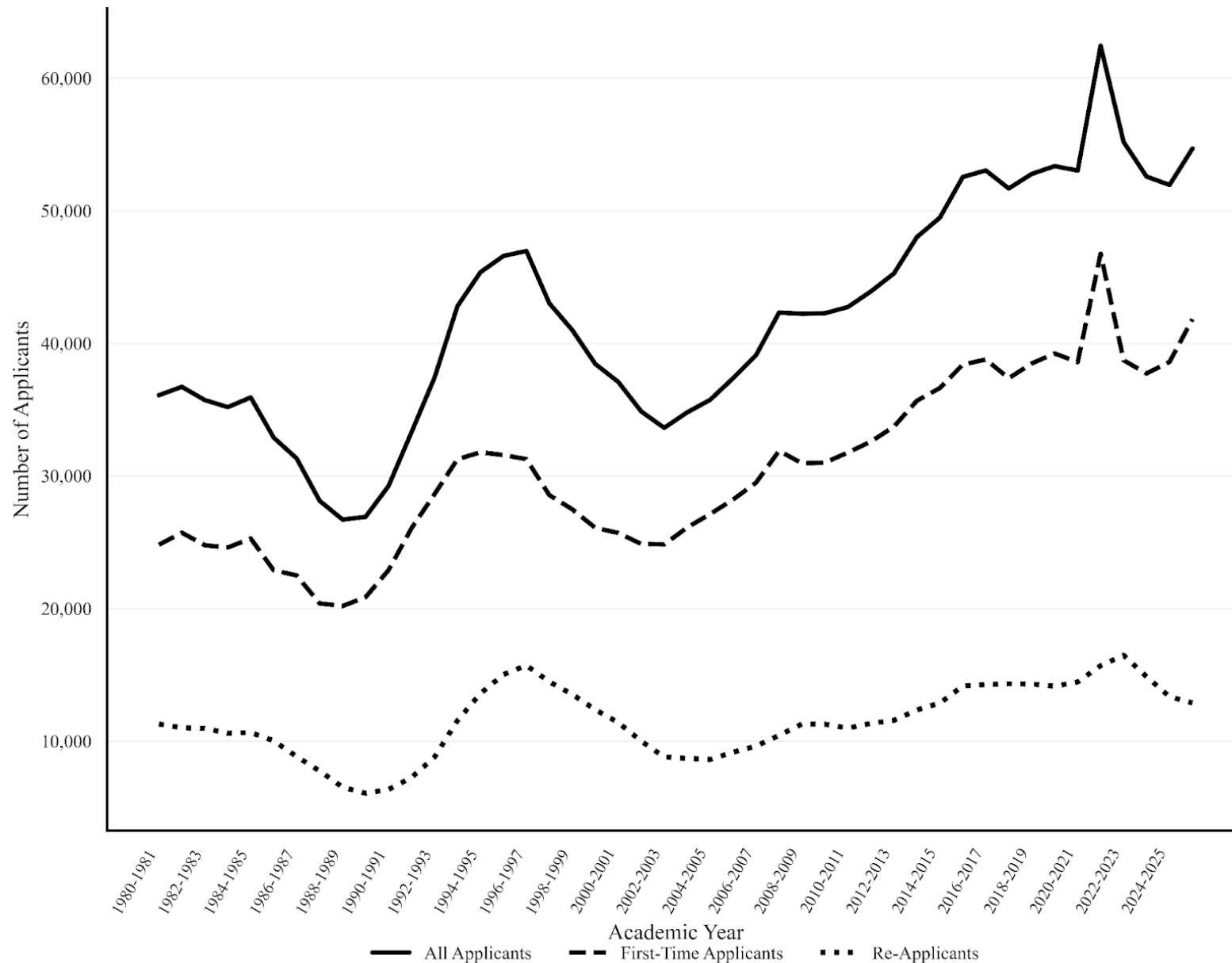
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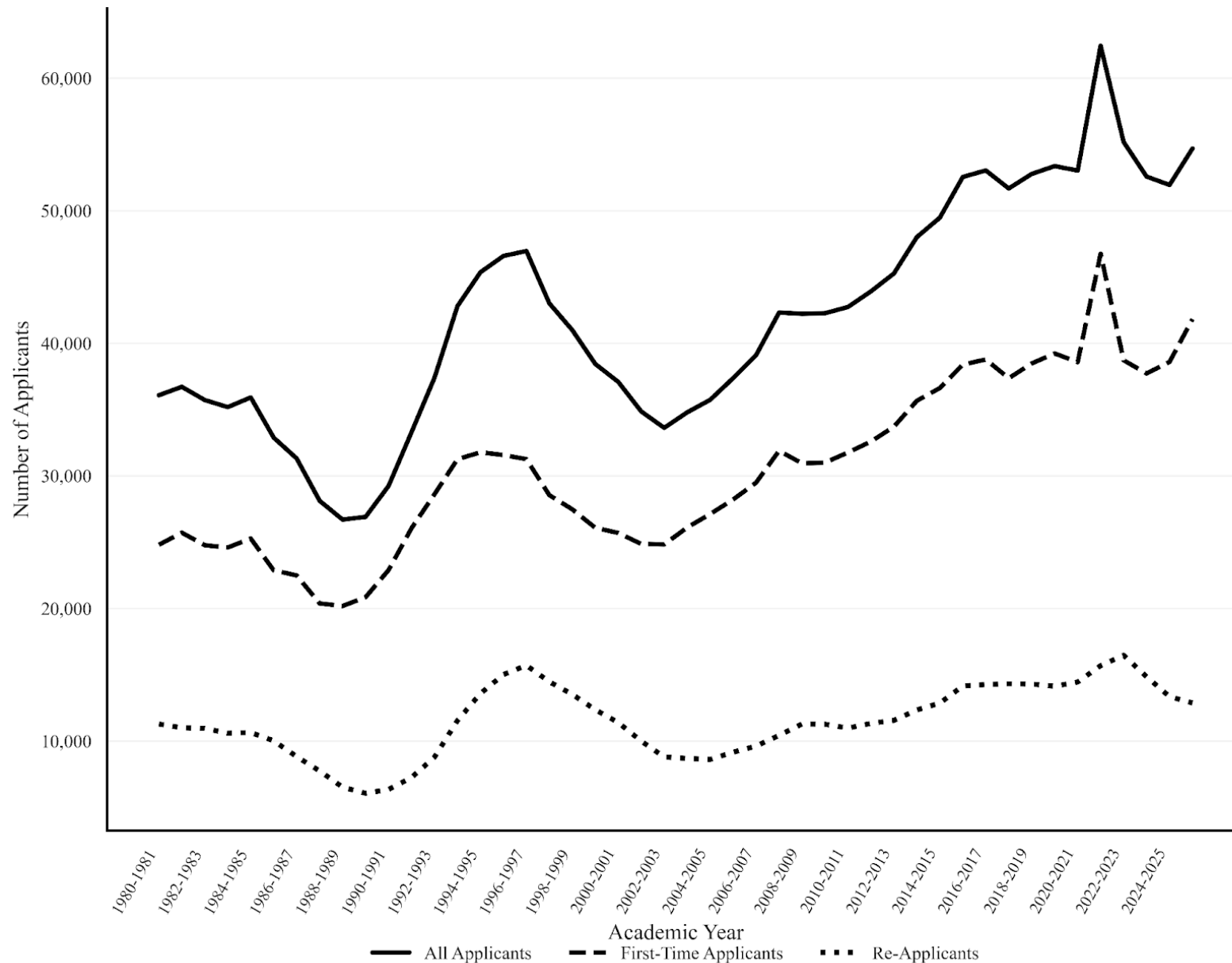
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○ **Pre-med arms race**

○ **But is it making better doctors?**

○ **Is the public investment trade-off worth it?**

THE SOLUTION?

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Sources

[3] Association of American Medical Colleges (AAMC). (2023 b). Matriculating Student Questionnaire: 2023 All Schools Summary Report. Association of American Medical Colleges. <https://www.aamc.org/data-reports/students-residents/report/matriculating-student-questionnaire-msq>

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[14] <https://flintmed.msu.edu/programs/lmu/mission.html>

[15] <https://humanmedicine.msu.edu/about/index.html>

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